

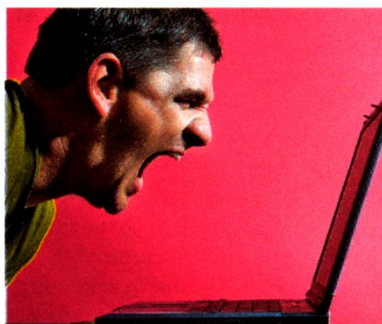
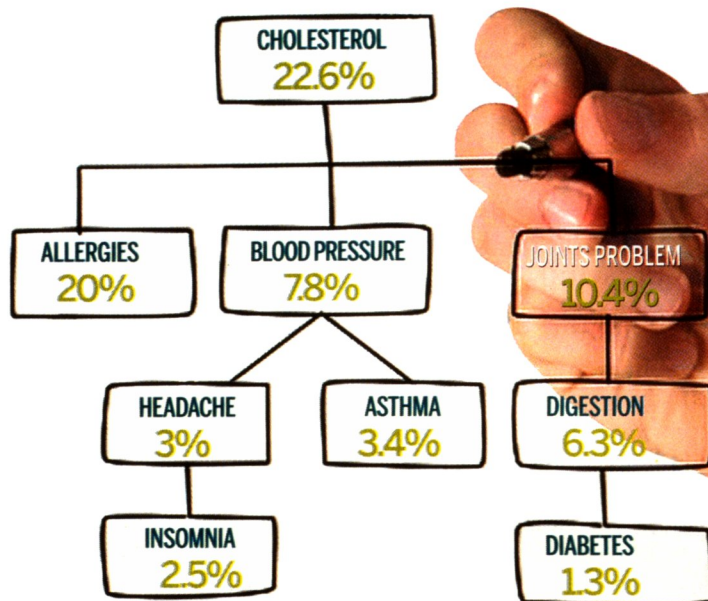


India, the findings were dismal," says Professor Adrian Kennedy of Lifetime Wellness Rx International Ltd, an Apollo initiative. To address the issue, the Apollo Group along with the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) instituted the annual CII Corporate Wellness awards. "The 2008-09 survey is a backgrounder to that," says Shobana Kamineni of Apollo, who mentored the project.

"The comparative study of the health profiles over 10 years contains good news and bad," says Kennedy. "There has been marked improvement in physical fitness and eating habits. Overall health seems to have improved. There's a much lower utilisation of medication, too."

But money, power or healthy attitude clearly do not buy happiness. Logging 60-plus hours a week, enduring 24/7 demands, facing severe competition in a time of recession, tighter-than ever deadlines, unpredictable work-flows, endless jet-lag, constant computer use, late nights, sleeplessness and the pressure of attending parties are the new beasts that shoot their stress levels up. "The study records much higher levels of stress at work and, as a consequence, at home," adds Kennedy. "No wonder, smoking and alcohol con-

IN THE PINK OF HEALTH Fall in chronic ailments in last 10 years



FLIP SIDE

Despite an improvement in health, the intensive use of computers has led to new health hazards such as repetitive strain injury and computer vision syndrome in the modern office. Although data is scarce, the rise in such ailments is being widely reported.

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Check out the data for 1998-99. It was a perfect picture of bad health: over 56 per cent of executives had multiple cardiac risk factors, over 30 per cent multi-factor cancer risk. About 70.89 per cent were overweight, 54.8 per cent were physically unfit, 83.71 per cent had psychosomatic ailments and 30 per cent were popping in pills every day. Zoom forward to 2008-09: the proportion of overweight executives dropped to 35.52 per cent; the number of physically unfit came down by 6.4 per cent; those with chronic ailments and risk

factors dropped to 48.24 per cent. Just 15 per cent are on daily medication, indicating an overall improvement in health.

What separates the two generations is not just time but a mindset (fat=prosperity) that turned upside down in the intervening decade. It hasn't happened in a vacuum, though. Says Kiran Mazumdar Shaw, India's richest businesswoman whose company, Biocon, ranks in the top league in Asia: "Globalisation has put intense pressure on Indian CEOs to perform and acquire global footprints." And globally, as analysed by

James Krohe Jr., writer and commentator on US public issues, the reshaping of collective values—the worship of youth, agility and physical beauty—has changed what a corporate soldier should look like: "The obsession with vigour in the executive ranks evidences a shift from veneration of wisdom to worship of youth." Not surprisingly, Americans are picking ever-younger corporate chiefs. Spencer Stuart, the recruiting firm, reports that 25 years ago, the average age of CEOs was around 60, now it's below 55. With it all, poor health—more often than not a fallout of bad